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Friday, 26 September 2025

Vedha Dhuri
Program Coordinator, Talent Development
DeakinTALENT, Deakin University

Dear Vedha,
RE: DeakinTALENT Career Ambassador Position - Burwood Campus

Hi Vedha, I am writing to apply for the DeakinTALENT Career Ambassador (Casual, HEW 1) role, as advertised on the DeakinTALENT Jobs & Internships portal. But let me begin with a story.

I landed in Melbourne, as an international student, two weeks later than planned because of visa delays, and by the time I stepped onto campus, O Week had already passed. Everyone around me kept saying that connections are everything in Australia, and I felt like I had already missed my chance to build them. It was intimidating, but I knew I could not sit back. I decided the only way forward was to throw myself into the very first opportunity I could find.

That opportunity turned out to be the DeakinTALENT Casual Jobs and Volunteer Showcase on the 22nd July 2025. I walked in unsure, spoke briefly with Dipika, one of the career coaches, and told her I had missed O-Week and did not know where to begin. Ten minutes later I left with a simple plan and a clearer head. That evening I opened the DeakinTALENT website and explored everything on offer - resume and cover letter support, one-to-one coaching, mock interviews, LinkedIn guidance, alumni panels, the Career Success Series, DISC programs, and practical advice for finding casual and part-time work. The FreelancingHUB and Pathways stood out because they made the Australian workplace feel understandable and achievable. For the first time since arriving, I felt seen, supported, and sure of my next steps.

A few days later, on August 4th, I attended the DISC Job Club event you ran with Michael on engaging with employers. I spoke with a current Ambassador and was able to briefly connect with you afterwards. When we connected on LinkedIn, you encouraged me to get in touch when I applied. That day, I promised myself I would join this team as soon as applications opened and this letter is me keeping that promise.

I'm a Master of Business Analytics student at Burwood, just through my first trimester and on track to graduate in 2027. Most of my growth has come from being proactive by taking on challenges even before I feel fully ready and learning as I go. Arriving late pushed me to engage from day one, so I make a point of showing up, whether that means asking questions, showing up at workshops, or putting myself forward in situations where I can learn. I value inclusivity, curiosity, and adaptability, which helps me be steady and approachable.

Alongside adjusting to a new country, I have built my skills through experiences where communication, initiative and teamwork mattered. Through school and college, I often served as the presenter for large events. Standing in front of an audience taught me to read the room, speak with clarity, and keep information easy to follow. It also made me comfortable handling last-minute changes and giving simple directions so things run on time.

I also volunteered for more than a year with an NGO called Aashray, in a people and HR capacity, running onboarding chats and regular check-ins with new volunteers. That work taught me to build rapport quickly, navigate awkward starts, ask open questions, and convert long conversations into clear next steps. Most recently I worked as an Executive Assistant at a marketing startup. I was the first point of contact for the CEO, speaking with senior stakeholders and clients, preparing agendas, writing concise briefs and emails, capturing decisions, and following up until actions were closed. Moving across teams sharpened my professional tone and kept my communication short and useful. Each of these roles helped me grow into someone who communicates with confidence, empathy, and intent.

Teamwork has always been where I learn the most. At Aashray, our group of 8 - 10 volunteers gathered on alternate evenings to teach children in their communities. We planned lessons together, rotated responsibilities, covered for one another during exams, and reflected after each session on what to improve. I also worked as a cyber volunteer with Chandigarh Police, where I worked in a team that created awareness campaigns for local businesses and senior citizens about cyber safety. This required me to adapt my communication to different audiences and explain complex topics in simple language. Both experiences deepened my patience, cultural awareness, and ability to collaborate.

I have also stepped up to lead. With AIESEC in Chandigarh, a youth-led organisation that develops leadership through cross-cultural projects , I was selected to the organising committee for the annual recruitment drive and volunteered to serve as OC President. Cold calling was daunting for the team, so I set small daily targets, shared call scripts that worked, kept quick check-ins, and added simple incentives to lift morale. We finished with the highest registration numbers in our chapter's history. Later, as the Head of Marketing for my college's annual fest, I managed sponsor outreach, coordinated with stallholders and vendor partners, and, on the day, moved into operations and logistics to keep stall placement, setup timing, and crowd flow on track, and learned that leadership means noticing gaps and stepping in before anyone asks.

One belief anchors me. Being teachable is the greatest skill. You learn nothing if you think you are right all the time. Holding onto that has helped me adapt quickly, stay open to feedback, and find growth in

every experience. It is what has allowed me to step into new teams, learn fast, and contribute meaningfully.

So when I think about why I want to join DeakinTALENT, the answer is simple. In the few months I've been here, I've already seen how DeakinTALENT transforms uncertainty into confidence. The workshops, coaching, and employer interactions are not just services, they're lifelines for students trying to find their place in a new environment. What excites me about becoming an ambassador is not only the chance to support students directly but also the opportunity to grow within such a purposeful program. The professional development workshops, the chance to meet employers at events, the office tours, and the internal network that Ambassadors build across the year are exactly the kind of learning experiences I value.For me, DeakinTALENT represents the best blend of giving back and moving forward and I want to play an active role in both.

I confirm that I am fully available for all professional development sessions listed in 2026 and any additional sessions throughout the year. From your eligibility list, I have also attended several DT and DISC sessions: How to Use LinkedIn and Your Profile; DISC: Lunch and Learn with Employers at Deakin Downtown on 15 August; How to Find Casual/Part-Time Jobs on 21 August, which you delivered; and most recently How to Get Ready to Apply for the DeakinTALENT Career Ambassador Position, which helped me shape this application. With that, I am also available for the Assessment Centre on Tuesday 21 October 2025 at Burwood. My employee Working With Children Check application has already been submitted and is currently in process.

Thank you for considering my application. Even in the short time I've been at Deakin, I've seen how meaningful DeakinTALENT is. As a Career Ambassador, I would not only be proud to share these opportunities with others but also to embody the same spirit of support that guided me when I first arrived. I'd welcome the chance to discuss in an interview about how I can contribute to a team that makes such a lasting difference.

Kind Regards,
Mehak Mehak